

Virtual anaesthesia

SnowWorld, a virtual-reality game distracts burn victims from pain
<http://slate.me/wo3eJC>

Social media network Cramlr

A social media platform aimed at teaching and helping you teach
<http://www.cramlr.com/?ref=b72438>

Nokia 700

Good hardware, let down by the ageing OS



Specifications

Platform: Symbian Belle;
Processor: ARM 11 single core
 1GHz, 512MB RAM; **Display:**
 3.2-inch AMOLED with 640
 x 360 pixels; **Storage:** 2GB
 internal + microSD; **Camera:**
 5MP with 720p videos;
Battery: 1080mAh

Contact

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Phone: +91 30303838
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Price: ₹18,099

6.0/10

Features 6.5
 Performance 6.0
 Build Quality 7.0
 Value for Money 6.0

The Nokia 700's dimension stats simply read 110x 50 x 9.7 (in mm). However, at 9.4 mm, Sony Ericsson Xperia Ray is thinner than the 700. But it weighs just 96 grams, four grams less than the Ray. Despite keeping the weight down so well, the build quality is literally flawless. It is plastic all around, but doesn't feel cheap or flimsy at all.

Before moving on to the hardware side of things, let us talk about the new OS on the block - Symbian Belle. While there are claims that serious design changes have been made to the UI, we think it still looks too similar to the Symbian Anna, or Symbian^3 for that matter. Yes, the icons have a slightly different treatment, you can set different wallpapers for all six home screens, and there are a couple of very useful new widgets. But, the problem is simple - it still feels archaic in the company of BlackBerry OS 7, let alone the likes of Android, Windows Phone and iOS.

Unfortunately, a few interface niggles have left us more confused than anything. For example, open the Maps application, click on Map from the homepage - now click on Search. Open search for a location. If you want to return back to the map, there seems to be no return option. Solution - exit Maps and open it again. Same with the camera. Maybe the OS installation on the phone had some issues, but even resetting it didn't help.

The menu still resembles the look of the old Symbian operating system - it is just one

long list. If you are in the Settings menu, or searching going through the options menu in most apps, it looks like a dated file system. We believe that streamlining it to a more visually appealing design would have made it easier for users to navigate through the wades of menu options, with sub menus and even a third layer of menus.

What we loved was the drop down notification bar. Very similar to the one we see on most Android phones, it offers instant access to settings for mobile data, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth and switching to the Silent profile. Belle also brings in support for Near Field Communication, popularly known as NFC.

An ARM11 1GHz processor powers the Nokia 700. With 512MB of RAM to play with, we felt there is enough headroom for background apps. At most times, Belle performs very well, with no performance issues. Queue 3-4 apps for download, and browse the web simultaneously. The phone will be fine while the apps are being downloaded, but slows down when the app is actually being installed on the device. Just to be sure, we stopped all app downloads and opened a couple of web pages, and let Facebook, Foursquare, Twitter, WhatsApp and Angry Birds shift to the background. No slowdowns in this case. Surprising, considering games like Need for Speed and Angry Birds run smoothly, but a task like app installation slows down the system.

The 3.2-inch display is the AMOLED version, with a reso-

lution of 640x360 pixels and Gorilla Glass. This phone also has the Nokia ClearBlack display technology, seen on the Lumia 800 and the Lumia 710. The colour depth is excellent, and we didn't see any gradations even on the usual suspects - light green and yellow. Text crispness is extremely good, allowing you to read even small font sizes.

In portrait mode, the keypad is quite painful to use - the keys are tiny and not spaced out at all. Typing is a slow and careful task. Things do become a bit better in the landscape mode, but the key size is still a tad too small for quick typing without spelling errors.

As a basic phone, the Nokia 700 is a solid device. The call quality is great, and it retains network signal where most other phones aren't able to, particularly in elevators. Ambient noise around the calling party is sufficiently blocked out.

If you happen to be using your phone for medium amount of voice calls, with constant connectivity to social networking and IM, the Nokia 700's tiny 1080mAh battery will last a day. The need for a bigger battery is imminent in such a case.

The Nokia 700 does come as a disappointment. While hardware specs are solid and phone is built very well, what disappoints is the OS. If you have the budget to spend on this phone, we suggest you consider the Nokia Lumia 710 - combination of excellent hardware and an amazing WP 7 user interface experience.

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thinkdigit

DETAILED REVIEW: bit.ly/digit_nokia700